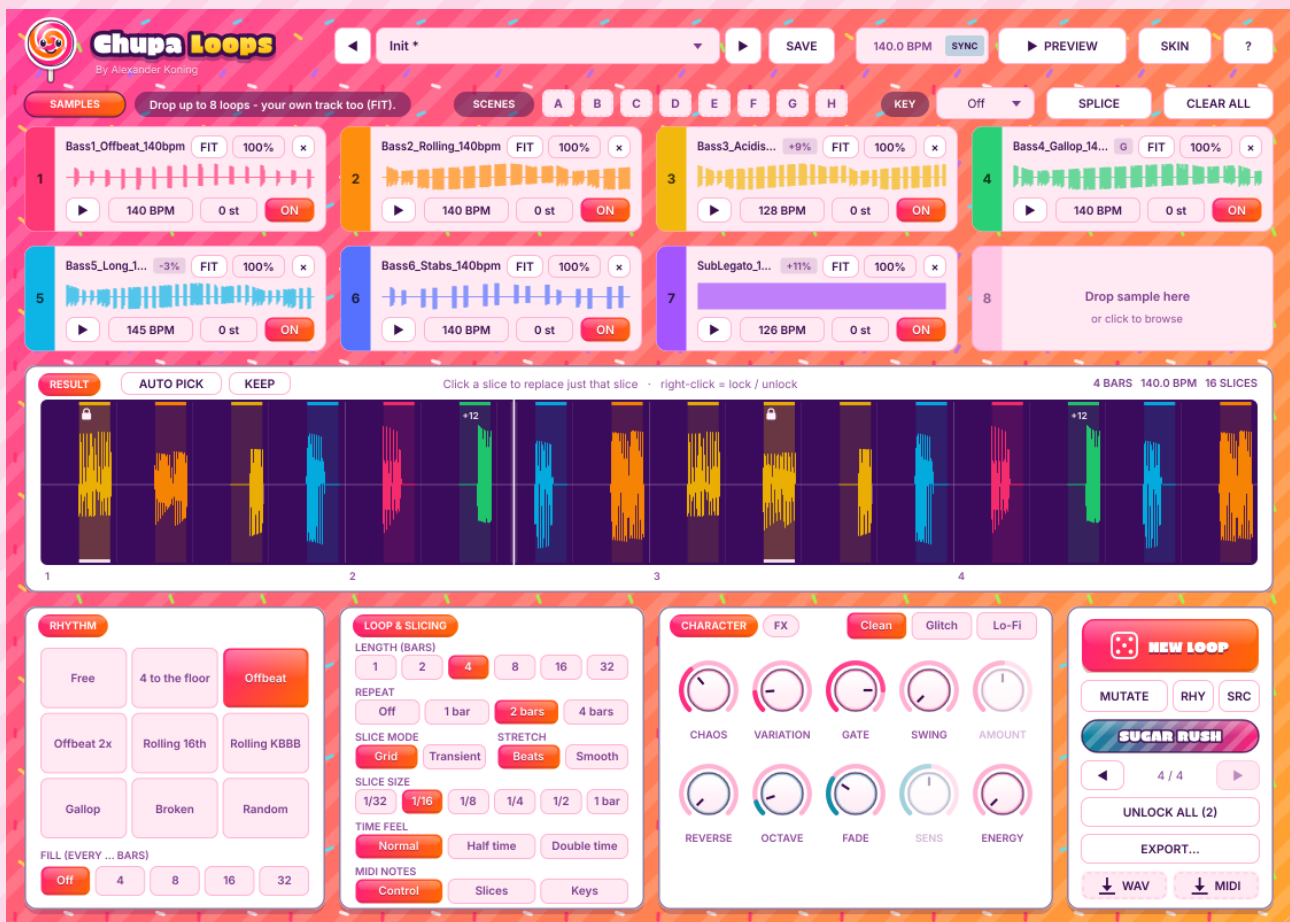




Chupa Loops

Loop slicer & loop generator - User manual



Version 1.1 - VST3, Audio Unit and standalone app for macOS and Windows - by Perception

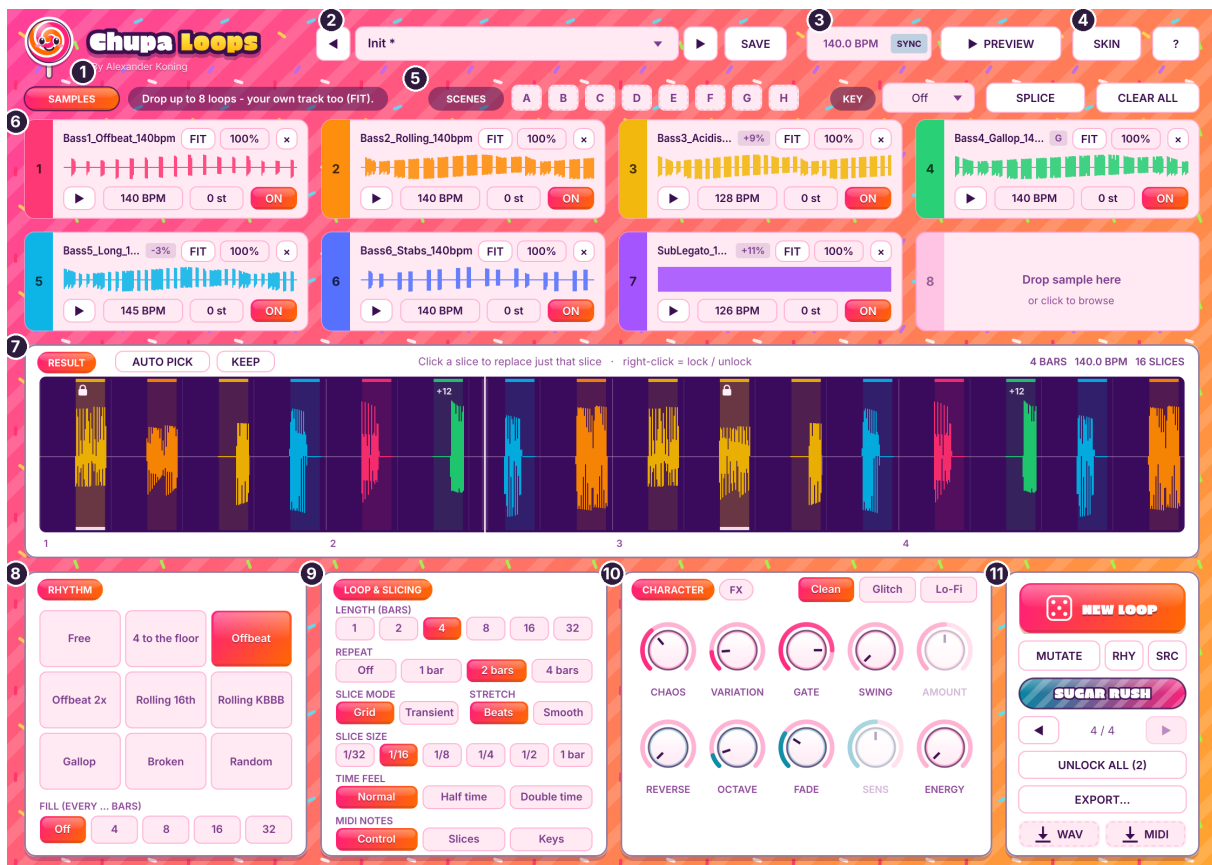
Welcome

Chupa Loops turns the loops you already have into new ones. Feed it up to 8 loops - basslines work great - and it cuts them into slices taken from **anywhere** in those loops, then puts the slices back together on the rhythm you choose. Every press of **NEW LOOP** gives you a fresh loop in the tempo and key of your song. Keep pressing until you love it, then drag it onto a track.

Quick start

- 1 Add Chupa Loops to an **instrument track** in your DAW (it is listed under instruments: **Percep-tion > Chupa Loops**). Or open the standalone app.
- 2 Drag 2 to 8 loops onto the slots - from Finder/Explorer, Splice or your DAW's browser. You can drop several files at once. Tempo and key are read from the file names, or heard in the audio when the name doesn't say.
- 3 Pick a **rhythm** (for example Offbeat or Rolling KBBB) and a **length**, or choose a preset from the preset bar at the top. Working on your own track? Drop a part of it in a slot and press **FIT** on that slot: the new loop then fits around it.
- 4 Press play in your DAW (or **PREVIEW**) and hit **NEW LOOP** until you hear something you like - or press **AUTO PICK** and let Chupa Loops make eight loops and keep the best one.
- 5 Click a slice to swap just that slice. Right-click a slice to **lock** it, so it stays when you make the next loop. **MUTATE** changes a few slices, **RHY** only the rhythm, **SRC** only the sounds. **KEEP** parks a loop in a scene (A - H).
- 6 Drag the loop out with **WAV** (audio) or **MIDI** (one note per slice), or use **EXPORT...** for a WAV, a MIDI file, a slice kit or stems.

The interface



1 Mascot	Your skin's mascot. It reacts every time a new loop is made.
2 Presets	◀ ▶ step through the presets, click the name to open the preset browser, SAVE stores your own. An asterisk (*) means you changed something since loading the preset.
3 Tempo & preview	Shows SYNC when the tempo comes from your DAW. In the standalone app it starts on 125 BPM; drag or double-click to set it, and your tempo is saved with the session. PREVIEW plays the loop without starting your DAW (it stops as soon as your DAW plays); in the standalone app the button reads PLAY.
4 Skin & ?	SKIN changes the look. ? opens the About screen: MIDI chart, version and update check.
5 Samples bar	Scenes A - H, KEY match, the SPLICE button and CLEAR ALL (click twice).
6 Slots	Eight sample slots: play button, name, FIT (this is my own track), share (%), tempo, transpose and on/off. See "Samples" below.
7 Result	The new loop: every colored block is a slice, colored by the slot it comes from. AUTO PICK and KEEP sit in its title row.
8 Rhythm	Where the slices land in the bar, and the phrase FILL.
9 Loop & slicing	Length, repeat, slice mode, stretch mode, slice size, TIME FEEL (half / double time) and MIDI NOTES (Control / Slices / Keys).
10 Character FX	Style (Clean / Glitch / Lo-Fi) and ten knobs (including ENERGY); the FX tab holds the finishing effects and the volume.
11 Actions	NEW LOOP, MUTATE / RHY / SRC, the skin's crazy button (see below), version history, unlock, EXPORT... and the WAV / MIDI drag tiles.

Samples

Drop a file on a slot, or click an empty slot to browse. WAV, AIFF, FLAC, MP3 and OGG are supported. Dropping several files fills the next free slots. Dropping on a loaded slot replaces it. Samples longer than about two minutes are shortened.

BPM field	The tempo of the sample, detected from the file name (Splice style: 128bpm, _140_), or from the loop length together with the beat it hears in the audio. Drag up/down to correct it (Shift = fine), double-click to go back to automatic.
st field	Transpose this slot by -12 to +12 semitones.
ON / OFF	Take this slot out of the mix without unloading it.
Play button	Listen to this sample on its own, at its own tempo, looping. Click again to stop; it also stops when your DAW plays.
FIT button	Marks this sample as your own track - see FIT TO TRACK below. Click again to turn it off: the % goes back to being a normal share and KEY goes back to what you had. Clearing the slot or dropping another file on it does the same.
Right-click	The slot menu: listen to the sample, clear it, or use it as my track - the same thing the FIT button does.

FIT TO TRACK

Drop a part of the track you are working on into a slot and press **FIT** on it. The button lights up, the slot gets a **MY TRACK** badge and its % turns into the fit strength. That sample is never sliced. Chupa Loops measures where your track is busy inside a bar and leaves those spots free, so the new loop fits around it instead of on top of it. The **KEY** also follows that sample. The % field of that slot is the strength: it starts at 100% = normal, 200% = really stay out of the way, drag it down to 0% to stop fitting. An even sound without a clear rhythm (a pad, a drone), or a sample shorter than one bar, gives nothing to fit around, so the loop stays as it was. Every bar always keeps a few slices - a quarter of the bar at 100%, fewer as you go up - and it keeps the ones on the quietest spots in your track, so **FIT** can never leave you with an empty loop, not even when your track and the rhythm you picked land on exactly the same beats.

Share (%)

How often slices are taken from this sample: 100% is a normal share, 0% means never, 200% twice as often. Drag up/down, double-click = 100%.

Tags

The key detected from the name (for example Am), the key it is moved to by **KEY** match (Am → F#m), and how much the loop is stretched (+9%).

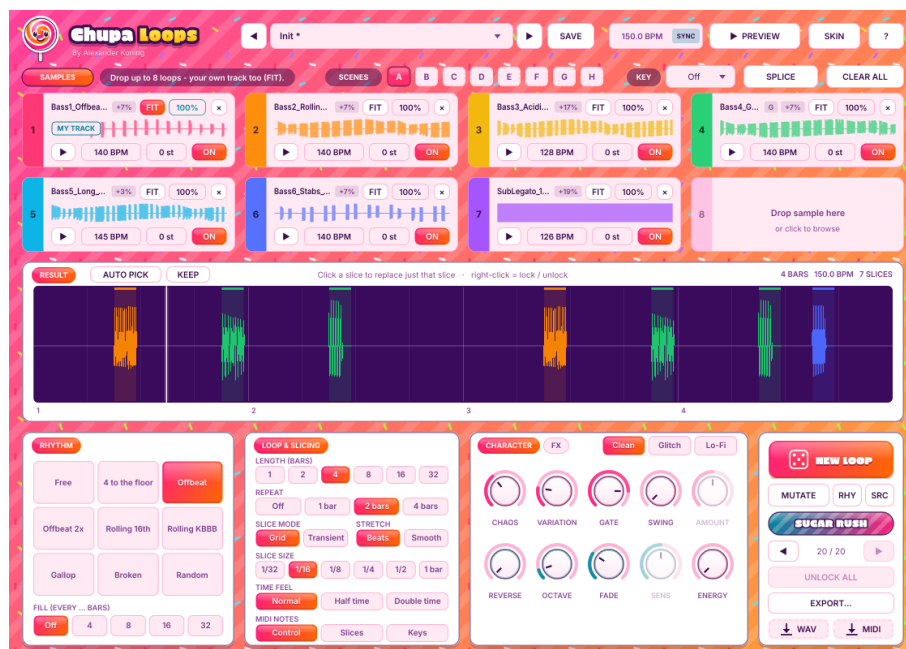
KEY

Key match: every sample with a known key is moved to the chosen key or its relative major/minor (Am fits C). Off = no change. The standalone app reopens on Off, so nothing is transposed behind your back - unless a slot is marked **MY TRACK**, then its key comes back with it. A project in your DAW, and a state file you load by hand, keep the key they were saved with. When the name has no key, Chupa Loops listens to the audio; it only sets a key when it is sure, and never for drum loops (names with kick, hats, drums, perc, top loop ...).

SPLICE

Opens Splice in your browser. Drag sounds from the Splice app, the Splice Sounds plug-in or the Splice tab in your DAW's browser (Fender Studio Pro has one) onto a slot. Tempo and key are read from the Splice file name. If Splice already matched a sound to your song's tempo, Chupa Loops notices that from its length. If Splice also matched the key, set **KEY** to Off so the sound isn't transposed twice.

Samples up to 64 seconds long are saved inside your project (compressed, lossless), so a project still opens when a file has moved.



Slot 1 is a part of your own track: the **FIT** button is lit, the slot says **MY TRACK** and its % is the fit strength. No slices are taken from that slot, and the loop keeps out of its way.

Result

Click a slice	Replaces just that slice with a new one.
Right-click a slice	Locks / unlocks it (Alt-click, Cmd-click on Mac or Ctrl-click on Windows works too). Locking freezes exactly what you are hearing: that slice keeps its sound through NEW LOOP, RHY, SRC and MUTATE.
Markers	Lock icon = locked, R = reversed, G = glitch, +12 = one octave up.
◀▶ and 1 / 4	Go back to earlier versions (up to 200 per session). A version comes back with its settings, so the crazy button can always be undone. Your FX moves stay.
MUTATE	A variation of this loop: about a quarter of the unlocked slices change, the rest stays.
RHY / SRC	Re-roll only the rhythm (same sounds) or only the sources (same groove).
AUTO PICK	Makes eight loops, gives them a score - enough going on, punchy, nicely spread over your samples, varied - and keeps the best one.
KEEP	Parks this loop in the first free scene, so you can keep looking without losing it.

Scenes A - H

Scenes keep your favorite loops ready to play live. Click an empty scene to store the current loop (with all its settings and FX), click a stored scene to bring it back. Shift-click stores (and replaces), right-click gives Store / Recall / Clear. The lit scene is the one you hear; it goes dark as soon as you change the loop. Scenes are saved with your project and can be played with MIDI notes C4 - G4.

Rhythm, loop & slicing

Rhythm	Free (back-to-back slices), 4 to the floor, Offbeat, Offbeat 2x, Rolling 16th, Rolling KBBB, Gallop, Broken, Random.
Length	1, 2, 4, 8, 16 or 32 bars.
Repeat	A 1, 2 or 4 bar motif comes back through the loop, so it stays musical. Off = every bar is new.
Slice mode	Grid = cut on the beat grid. Transient = cut at every new note.
Stretch	How loops at another tempo are fitted. Beats (best for basslines) re-slices on the grid, so attacks stay exactly as recorded. Smooth time-stretches (best for long notes and pads).
Slice size	1/32 to 1 bar: the slice length in Free mode and the grid that random positions are taken from.
Fill	Off, 4, 8, 16 or 32 bars: the last half bar of every phrase becomes a stutter roll that gets faster, like a drummer's fill. A loop shorter than the fill length gets its fill at the end of the loop.
Time feel	Half time plays your samples at half speed, Double time twice as fast. The beat grid and the loop length stay the same.
MIDI notes	What incoming MIDI notes do: Control (the chart below), Slices or Keys - see "Play it as an instrument".

Character

Style	Clean: seamless, phase-aligned joins. Glitch: stutters, tape stops and chops. Lo-Fi: a crunchy vintage sampler.
Chaos	Low: slices come from random places but keep their spot in the beat (tight groove). High: anything goes.
Variation	With Repeat on: how many slices change in each repeat of the motif.
Gate	Note length. Lower = shorter and stabber.
Swing	Pushes every second 1/16 back for a shuffle.
Amount	Strength of Glitch or Lo-Fi.
Reverse / Octave	Chance that a slice plays backwards / one octave up.
Fade	Crossfade between slices: short = punchy, long = smooth.
Sens	Transient detection sensitivity (Transient mode).
Energy	Builds the loop up: the further into the loop, the more rolls, octaves and reverses. 0% = the same from start to end.
Volume	Output level (in the FX tab), -36 to +12 dB. A transparent limiter keeps the sliced loop at -0.3 dBFS, before Volume and the FX.

Every knob: Shift-drag = fine, double-click = default, right-click = MIDI learn. The window can be resized by dragging its corner (75% to 200%); the size is remembered with your project.

FX

The FX tab is the finishing touch on the whole loop - it is not a per-step effect sequencer. The effects are in the playback, in exports and in the drag tiles.

Cutoff / Reso	Low-pass filter over the loop and its resonance. 100% = open.
Env / Decay	Opens the filter on every slice and lets it close again over the Decay time: every chop gets its own "wow" (use Cutoff below 100%).
Low cut	Removes low end, to make room for your kick and bass.
Drive	Warm saturation up to distortion.
Pump	Sidechain pump on every beat, in time with your song.
Width	Stereo width: 0% mono, 100% unchanged, 200% extra wide.

Presets from the factory don't touch the FX, Fill and Time feel, so you can browse presets with your finishing layer on. ENERGY does go back to 0% with a factory preset. Init resets everything; your own presets store the FX too.

Into your song

WAV tile	Drag the loop as audio onto an audio track. A copy is kept in Music/Chupa Loops (MIDI drags land in MIDI, kits in Kits, stems in Stems).
MIDI tile	Drag the loop as MIDI onto the Chupa Loops track: one note per slice. Set MIDI NOTES to Slices and the notes play the loop back exactly. Now move, delete or repeat notes to re-arrange your loop in the piano roll.
EXPORT...	Loop as WAV (24-bit, or 32-bit float when Volume pushes the loop above 0 dBFS), Loop as MIDI , a slice kit : a folder in Music/Chupa Loops/Kits with the full loop, every different slice as its own WAV (named after its key) and the MIDI file - ready for any sampler. Stems writes one WAV per sample (the same loop, but only the slices of that sample), so you can mix them yourself. Stems are dry: Lo-Fi and the limiter only run on the mix.

Play it as an instrument

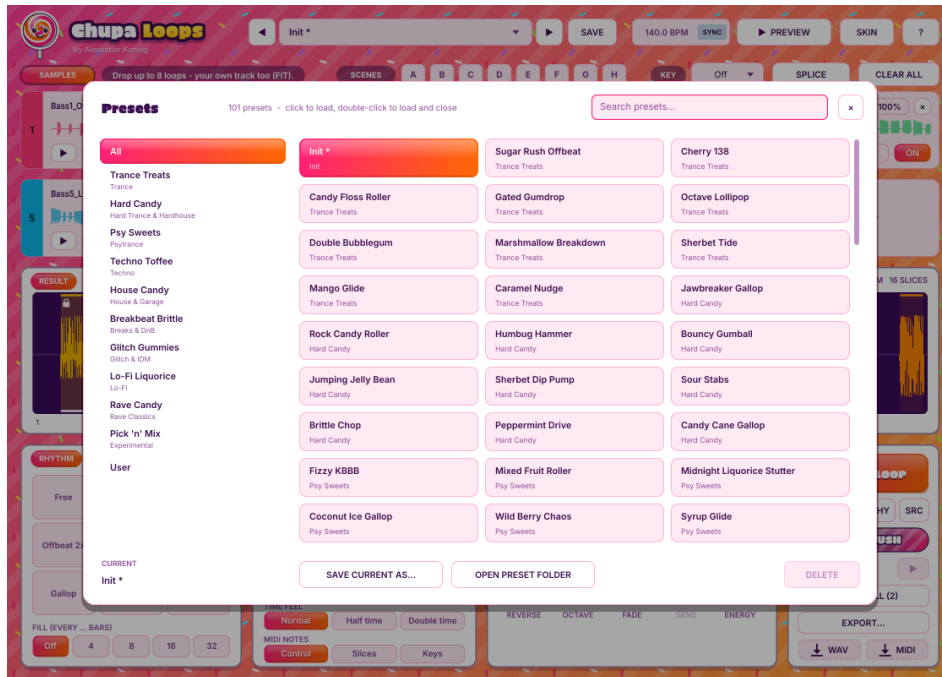
Slices	C1 plays the whole loop, C#1 and up play every different slice on its own key (a slice that repeats in the loop shares its key). Up to 91 different slices fit on the keyboard (C#1 up to G8); with more, use Repeat or a shorter loop. Velocity sets the level.
Keys	Hold a key and the loop plays in that key, in time with your song: C3 = original pitch, up to two octaves up or down. Play a bassline or chords with your new loop.
Control	The standard mode: notes control Chupa Loops (see MIDI control).

Presets

Chupa Loops comes with **100 presets** in ten flavors. A preset sets the rhythm, length, slicing, style and character - never your samples, the key or the volume - so you can flip through presets with the same loops loaded.

Flavor	Style of music
Trance Treats	Trance
Hard Candy	Hard trance & hardhouse
Psy Sweets	Psytrance
Techno Toffee	Techno
House Candy	House & garage
Breakbeat Brittle	Breaks & drum and bass
Glitch Gummies	Glitch & IDM
Lo-Fi Liquorice	Lo-fi
Rave Candy	Rave classics
Pick 'n' Mix	Experimental

Click the preset name to open the **browser**: pick a flavor on the left, search by name or style, click a preset to hear it (the browser stays open) and double-click to load it and close. **SAVE** (or SAVE CURRENT AS... in the browser) stores your own preset in Music/Chupa Loops/Presets (the browser has an OPEN PRESET FOLDER and a DELETE button, an **All** category, and the search box also matches the style). Presets are small files (.chupapreset): copy them to another computer or send them to a friend, and drop one on the plug-in window to import it. The standalone app also has [and] for the previous / next preset. Your DAW sees the factory presets as programs.



Skins

Click **SKIN** to pimp your Chupa. Your choice is remembered for every project and every instance. Lolly and Fruity share the swirl lolly in their own colours; Skull, Butcher, Neon, Acid and Smile each have their own: a skull lolly, a lolly with a steel cleaver chopping into it, a neon lolly, an acid lolly with a bubbling flask and a smiley lolly. The Butcher even chops the name: it reads **Chopa Loops**.



Top: Lolly, Fruity, Skull, Butcher. Bottom: Neon, Acid, Smile.

The craziest loop ever

Under NEW LOOP sits the skin's **crazy button**. It throws the rhythm, slicing and character around in the style of the skin and makes a new loop straight away. Your samples, length, key, stretch mode and volume are never touched. Liked it? Save it as a preset. Too much? Load your preset again to calm down.

SUGAR RUSH (Lolly)	Maximum chaos, octave jumps and stutters on rolling rhythms.
FRUIT PUNCH (Fruity)	Bouncy and swung, with lots of octave jumps.
SKULL DAMAGE (Skull)	Crushed Lo-Fi, backwards slices, broken rhythms.
THE BUTCHER CUT (Butcher)	Tiny, stabby chops on every transient.
NEON OVERDRIVE (Neon)	Rolling and glitchy, lit up with octaves.

ACID FLASHBACK (Acid)	Smeared, backwards and swung, with Glitch or Lo-Fi.
SMILEY MAYHEM (Smile)	Anything goes: every setting at random.

MIDI control

Send MIDI to the Chupa Loops track (play notes on a keyboard, or draw them in a MIDI clip) to control it live. These notes work with MIDI NOTES set to **Control**; in Slices and Keys the notes play the loop instead.

MIDI	Does
C1 (note 36)	New loop
C#1 / D1	Previous / next version
D#1	Unlock all slices
E1	The skin's crazy button
F1	Mutate
C2 - G#2	Rhythm: C2 Free, C#2 4 to the floor, D2 Offbeat, D#2 Offbeat 2x, E2 Rolling 16th, F2 Rolling KBBB, F#2 Gallop, G2 Broken, G#2 Random
C3 - F3	Length: C3 1 bar, C#3 2, D3 4, D#3 8, E3 16, F3 32 bars
C4 - G4	Scenes A - H
Program change	0 = Init, 1 - 100 = the factory presets

Note names use middle C = C3 (note 60), as in Studio Pro, Logic, Cubase and Ableton Live. Other DAWs may call note 36 "C2" (or "C3" in FL Studio): it is always the lowest C of the chart, note number 36.

MIDI learn

Right-click any knob, selector or the NEW LOOP button and choose **MIDI learn**, then move a knob or fader on your controller. A small CC tag shows the mapping. Right-click again and choose **Forget** to remove it. Mappings are saved with your project. Learn is cancelled by clicking anywhere, by pressing Escape, or after 20 seconds.

Automation

Every control can be automated. The extra **New Loop** parameter makes a new loop every time it goes from off to on: draw it as short steps in an automation lane to get a new loop on, say, every 8th bar. When you export or bounce, automated settings are followed exactly. New loops made by MIDI notes or the New Loop parameter are made the moment they arrive, so in a fast offline bounce they can land a little later than in real time: for an exact result, record the loops you like with the WAV tile.

Working in your DAW

Fender Studio Pro	Drag Chupa Loops from the Browser (Instruments) onto the arrangement. It follows the song tempo; press play. Drag your loops and Splice samples straight from the Browser onto the slots.
Logic Pro	Create a Software Instrument track and choose AU Instruments > Perception > Chupa Loops.
Ableton Live	Plug-ins > VST3 (or Audio Units) > Perception > Chupa Loops, on a MIDI track. Drag the loop from the WAV tile into an audio track or Session slot.
Cubase	Add an Instrument Track with Chupa Loops (Perception, category Sampler).
FL Studio	Scan for plug-ins in the Plugin Manager, then add Chupa Loops to the Channel Rack.

When exporting or bouncing, Chupa Loops waits until the loop is ready, so the bounce always contains the final loop.

Standalone app

The app works without a DAW. Set your audio device under **Options**. Shortcuts: **Space** play/stop, **N** new loop, **Cmd/Ctrl+Z** previous version, **Shift+Cmd/Ctrl+Z** next version, **[]** previous/next preset.

Installation

Mac	Open ChupaLoops-macOS.dmg and double-click Chupa Loops Installer.pkg . It installs the VST3, the Audio Unit and the app (click Customize to choose). If macOS says it can't check the installer, go to System Settings > Privacy & Security and click Open Anyway .
Windows	Run ChupaLoops-Windows-Setup.exe . It installs the VST3 in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3 and the app in Program Files. If SmartScreen warns you, click More info > Run anyway.
Manual install	The .zip downloads contain the plug-ins as files, for copying by hand.

Updates: open ? and click **CHECK FOR UPDATES**. Chupa Loops only goes online when you click that button. A short tour opens the first time; ? > SHOW THE TOUR opens it again.

Troubleshooting

I can't find the plug-in	Restart your DAW and rescan plug-ins. Chupa Loops is an instrument , not an effect.
No sound	Press play in your DAW or click PREVIEW. Check that at least one slot is ON and Volume is up.
Wrong tempo for a sample	Drag the BPM field of that slot to the right tempo (double-click = automatic again).
MIDI notes do nothing / play sound	Check MIDI NOTES: Control = the notes control Chupa Loops, Slices and Keys = the notes play the loop.
The MIDI clip sounds wrong	Set MIDI NOTES to Slices, and use the clip with the loop it was dragged from (a new loop has other slices).
Loops clash harmonically	Set KEY, or transpose single slots with the st field.
The loop sounds empty	Check the slots: a sample marked as MY TRACK is never sliced, a share of 0% means that sample is never used, and a high FIT leaves a lot of room for your track - turn its % down, or press FIT again to switch it off.
AUTO PICK does nothing	It needs samples and a loop, and it takes a moment: it makes eight loops first. The result line tells you the score.
Joins sound soft	Use Stretch: Beats, lower Fade, or raise Gate.
A file is red: "File not found"	Click the slot to locate the file. The audio is also stored in the project, so the loop keeps working.
Typing in the preset name does nothing	Some DAWs keep the keyboard for themselves. Click inside the text field first, or allow keyboard input for plug-ins in your DAW.

Credits

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